

## Rep. Tom Emmer on Twin Cities News Talk

KTLK

Broadcast: 2026-05-19 • Duration: 8:06

---

### HOST JOHN:

representative Tom Emmer, who joins us once again this morning. Good morning, Tom. How are we doing this morning?

### REP. TOM EMMER:

We're doing great, John. We're doing great.

### HOST JOHN:

What are your, let's start off here. We're going to get an update on the end of the legislative session with a Luke Sprinkle from Alpha News on tomorrow's show. We've been talking just about what the GOP was able to accomplish, and more specifically, what they were able to stop in terms of the DFL agenda. It shows you and demonstrates the importance of elections and how, if it wasn't for that divided house here in the state, the state would have been in big, big trouble like we were during the trifecta. But Tom, your thoughts on the end of the legislative session?

### REP. TOM EMMER:

It's what should be expected. It was both pathetic and it was a relief. It was a relief from the standpoint that you just talked about, John. I mean, your Second Amendment rights, they didn't go after the life issue anymore. I mean, if it weren't for the leadership of Republicans in the Minnesota House of Representatives and how close it is in the Minnesota Senate, the damage, much like it would have been under Kamala in the fraudster Tim Walz, if they would have ever gotten into the White House, it would have made it almost impossible to come back. It was also a relief. I'm sorry, it was also pathetic. Do you realize, Minnesotans, you and me, John, and every other Minnesotan, is not going to get the benefit of the federal tax reform that was done almost a year ago in the big, beautiful bill. You're not gonna be able to deduct from your state taxes, taxes on tips, taxes on overtime. I mean, they just refuse to help the working men and women because they refuse to get their budget under control because they refuse to get fraud under control. And by the way, all that nonsense about the new fraud measures, really? Really? That should have been done seven, eight years ago, John. That was pathetic.

### HOST JOHN:

Well, on the \$1,700 school choice credit, find me a better example of just how irrational Democrats have become than not allowing that to move through just simply out of spite. It doesn't cost a dime to the taxpayer apart from the individuals taking advantage of it. And yet, because of just, in my view, Tom, their hatred of Trump and Republicans, they refused to go and move forward on it. I know you mentioned it. I just wanted to express my frustration with that as well.

### REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, but it's worse than that, John. You're pointing out their hatred. Tim Walz hates faith based schools. Tim Walz hates charter schools. Tim Walz hates anything except schools that are literally controlled and run by the cartel, which is the teachers union. It goes beyond that. And I hope Minnesotans are starting to pay attention, because for far too long, the people who decide elections in Minnesota, those people right now who aren't wearing the partisan jersey, they don't do what I do year round. They're just trying to pay a mortgage, put food on the table, put clothes on the kids. They're hoping to have a great family vacation this summer, John. But when they wake up, when they start thinking about the election in November, this does matter. I mean, you can continue to vote for this Marxist, socialist, communist party that used to be my grandfather's Democrat party. Or you can vote for people who actually want to protect your rights, your individual freedoms, your right to self-determine when it comes to you and your family. I mean, I think the choice is pretty easy. The contrast is, our friend Newt Gingrich has said, this is not a contract with America. This is a contrast for America. And the contrast is between common sense and flat out crazy, John. Common sense should win.

## HOST JOHN:

I've had consistently from friends of the show talking about their frustration over the lack of Congress codifying what President Donald Trump has accomplished. And I know that you wanted to take a moment and mention the not codifying of the federal tax cuts. I know you mentioned this a moment ago, but would you care to expand upon that a bit there, Tom?

## REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, here's the thing. We've just put those two together. The failure to codify the tax cuts, that is a state issue completely. You're always doing, when I was in the legislature, we would do a federal tax compliance law. In other words, the Minnesota law would conform to the federal changes. They are refusing to do that. And by some accounts, they're refusing to do that because I've heard the statement that no taxes on tips would cost our state \$200 million. So all your working men and women out there, think about that for a second. They don't wanna give you your \$200 million back. They wanna spend it. The federal government wants to give it back. When it comes to frustration with us at the federal level, we have codified a bunch of Trump's priorities. A bunch of them were codified in the big, beautiful bill a year ago. But I mean, we haven't done them all. And the biggest frustration, John, that I'm hearing is the failure of the Save America Act, the simple voter identification, citizenship proof bill that over 70% of Democrats even support. This is an American issue. And my frustration, I think, is on a level with the president's. Now, there are no Republicans. There are no Democrats over in the Senate. There are just senators. And they can override the parliamentarian if they choose. They choose not to. They hide behind the parliamentarian. They can override the filibuster. They've done it for judges in the past. They can modify it, they can get rid of it. They choose not to. They choose to hide behind it. The only way you get stuff done here in Washington, DC, and I can tell you this as the whip, and I've had this conversation with the president, you gotta put it up for a vote, John. People have to vote yes or no so that they can be revealed to their constituents and they can be held accountable. If you're not willing to vote, then you're not representing the American people. That's my belief.

## HOST JOHN:

Representative Tom Emmer, let's just end on a positive note. It was really amazing to see over the weekend the rededication 250, the event taking place in Washington, DC, and all those amazing speakers. What a contrast to the many times as of late the leftists have taken to the streets of America to see so many people out in mass, not only celebrating America, but celebrating their love of our Lord and Savior, expressing their faith as well. That was a great positive thing to see. Great for the country over the weekend, Tom.

**REP. TOM EMMER:**

But without a doubt, make no mistake about it, this is a Christian nation, John. There is no question that we are a Christian nation founded on Christian principles, and those are being reaffirmed every day. The more important thing is, John, we, you and I, are not in the minority in this country. We are the majority in this country. The problem is, as I described earlier, the vast majority of people are just living their lives and they don't pay attention to who's running their state, running their country. That's kind of changed. I'm so happy to be part of the Americans that celebrate 250 years of the greatest constitutional republic, the greatest experiment in self-governance that the world has ever seen. And let's get ready to save it with Donald J. Trump and preserve it for the next 250 years, John.

**HOST JOHN:**

Representative Tom Emmer, as always, thank you for the time. I look forward to talking with you again next week and have a great rest of your week.

**REP. TOM EMMER:**

All right, John, you too. Happy Memorial Day.

---

This transcript was independently produced by MN-06 Watch for accountability and archival purposes.

Source: KTLK (2026-05-19)

Archived: May 20, 2026

Source URL: <https://youtu.be/-GCiwPnJtVs>

For questions or corrections: [mn06watch@gmail.com](mailto:mn06watch@gmail.com)